

I Took 5 Peptides for 3 Weeks... Here's What Happened

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 15, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JK9MgJZhtwU> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter documents his personal 3-week experiment stacking five prescription peptides for fat loss, muscle preservation, energy, and recovery — reporting ~10 lbs lost, dramatically suppressed appetite, improved sleep, and reduced chronic joint pain, all supervised by a doctor with monthly bloodwork.

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Disclaimer & Sourcing Philosophy 0:00

- Explicitly tells viewers **not** to do peptides without consulting a doctor first
 - Extends the joke broadly: "Don't take creatine... ask your doctor what time to set your alarm" — emphasizing that any health intervention warrants professional guidance
- Gets all peptides from a licensed medical doctor via prescription — not from websites or informal sources
 - "I'm not out here going on shady websites or buying them from some guy I know because I need to know exactly what's in it"
 - Describes buying peptides from unverified sources as "playing Russian roulette with your health"
- Doing monthly bloodwork with his doctor; will share week-4 blood work in a follow-up video
- Frames the video purely as personal experience reporting, not medical advice: "I'm just a guy yelling at the camera"

The Five-Peptide Stack Overview 0:46

- The five peptides he is running simultaneously:

- Tirzepatide (GLP-based fat loss / appetite suppression)
- Tesamorelin (visceral fat reduction / muscle preservation)
- MOTS-c (mitochondrial energy / metabolic flexibility)
- Ipamorelin (growth hormone / sleep / fat loss)
- BPC-157 (healing / recovery)
- Goal: get to **5–6% body fat** starting from an already-lean baseline, not from a high body-fat starting point
- Told his doctor: "I want you to turn me into Luke Cage" — used as shorthand for peak physical optimization
- Notes it is hard to isolate which peptide is causing which effect since he is stacking all of them

Tirzepatide: Appetite Suppression & Fat Loss 1:11

- A GLP-class peptide (similar mechanism to Ozempic/semaglutide but hits two GLP receptors vs. one)
- Primary mechanism: dramatically reduces hunger, forcing a caloric deficit
- His personal experience:
 - Has not felt hungry at all over three weeks
 - Describes appetite suppression as almost working "too good"
 - Has to actively remind himself to eat; risks accidentally doing a 24-hour fast
 - Currently drinking **over 100 grams of protein per day from shakes** just to hit protein targets
 - Is on a very low dose — **2.5 mg** — and considering dropping to 2 mg
- Compared to his previous appetite-suppression stack (caffeine + BHB ketones):
 - The old stack also suppressed appetite but would cause weakness/energy crashes if he skipped eating
 - Tirzepatide produces no such weakness — he simply forgets about food with no negative sensation
- Cognitive/focus effect:
 - Reports being able to focus and "lock in" much more
 - Unsure if it's a true nootropic effect or simply the result of not thinking about food every few hours
 - Previously would do 24–48 hour fasts specifically to avoid food distraction during heavy work days; tirzepatide replicates that state passively
- Data-backed claim: proven in studies to drive **15–20% body fat reduction**
- Also increases insulin sensitivity
- Why he didn't use Retatrutide (triple GLP agonist):
 - No legal prescription pathway available to him
 - The third receptor Retatrutide hits can **speed up heart rate** in many users — he didn't want that side effect
 - His rationale: "I'm not fat... I just want to get super ripped" — a triple agonist's extra fat-burning would be overkill for his starting point

Tesamorelin: Visceral Fat & Muscle Preservation 5:22

- **FDA-approved** peptide, specifically indicated for deep abdominal / visceral fat reduction
- Mechanism: stimulates natural growth hormone production
 - Visceral fat = fat stored around organs inside the abdominal cavity
- Dual benefit for his cut:
 - Targets visceral fat directly
 - Helps preserve muscle mass while in a caloric deficit (via elevated GH)
- Does NOT suppress appetite — that role is handled by Tirzepatide
- Taken **before bed**, combined with Ipamorelin at night
- He calls this "hitting fat loss from two different angles" alongside Tirzepatide
- Sleep improvement noted when taking Tesamorelin alone; effect amplified when combined with Ipamorelin

⚡ **MOTS-c: Energy, Mitochondria & Metabolic Flexibility 6:24**

- A mitochondria-derived peptide
- Often called **"exercise in a bottle"** because it mimics the cellular effects of exercise
- Key mechanisms:
 - Boosts cellular energy / mitochondrial performance
 - Enhances insulin sensitivity
 - Improves metabolic flexibility (ability to switch between fuel sources)
- His experience:
 - Dramatically increased energy throughout the day — feels "turned up and ready to go" without the jitteriness of stimulants
 - Had been taking up to **1,000 mg of caffeine per day** for ~20 years; cut that in half since starting MOTS-c
 - Was occasionally napping once or twice per week for extra energy — has not been compelled to nap at all
 - Attributes the clean, sustained energy specifically to MOTS-c
 - Notes the energy feels different from caffeine: "Not turned up like I'm on caffeine, but turned up like I'm just ready to go every day"
- Likely also responsible for some of the nootropic / focus effect he notices (previously attributed tentatively to Tirzepatide)
- Some recovery benefit as well (minor, compared to BPC-157)

😴 **Ipamorelin: Sleep Quality & Growth Hormone 8:22**

- A growth hormone secretagogue peptide
- Protocol: taken **before bed** alongside Tesamorelin
- Important clarification he adds mid-edit: he is NOT stacking CJC-1295 with Ipamorelin simultaneously

- CJC and Ipamorelin "kind of compete" and taking both at the same time would be wasteful
- He went: CJC/Ipamorelin blend → switched to Tesamorelin alone → now back to Tesamorelin + Ipamorelin at night (no CJC)
- Benefits:
 - Better sleep quality
 - Elevated growth hormone → better fat loss, muscle recovery
 - Promotes **lipolysis** (breakdown of fat cells into fatty acids)
 - Explains the two-step fat loss process:
 - Step 1 — Lipolysis: fat cell breaks down into fatty acids
 - Step 2 — Oxidation: body burns those fatty acids for energy
- His sleep results (attributed to Tesamorelin + Ipamorelin combo):
 - Best sleep in **at least 10 years** by his own assessment
 - Waking up **before his alarm** feeling ready to go — typically 30 minutes early, once a full hour early
 - Oura Ring data confirms: high amounts of **deep sleep and REM sleep**
 - Sleep latency down to **under 5 minutes** (falls asleep very quickly)
 - Not sleeping as many total hours but feels fully rested — quality over quantity
 - "My body's like, 'Hey man, you good. Let's turn up.'"

BPC-157: Healing & Recovery 10:43

- Nicknamed the "**Wolverine peptide**" for its regenerative properties
- Targets:
 - Tears and damaged tissue
 - Joint and ligament issues
 - Gut inflammation
- His personal injury history and results:
 - Chronic nagging trap pain from **10+ years of daily handstand push-ups**
 - Old left bicep injury from earlier in life — was never fully healed
 - Both pains were not debilitating but were persistently present for years
 - Now: "I have to look for the pain" — can still detect a faint sensation only when actively searching for it
 - Before BPC-157: pain was just always there and he had "learned to deal with it"
- Compared to a previous treatment:
 - Previously paid a significant amount for an injection treatment similar to stem cells (called **Exosome** therapy — he couldn't recall the name during filming)
 - That treatment produced minimal improvement; felt like wasted money
 - BPC-157 is **cheaper** and producing better results

- Acknowledges the placebo effect is possible but says: "I don't care how I get the results as long as I'm getting the results"
- Caveat on evidence base: some peptides lack extensive human trials; Tesamorelin and Tirzepatide are the two he considers most proven (both FDA-approved for human use)

 Full Stack Summary & Results 13:02

- Overall reported results after 3 weeks:
 - Down approximately **10 lbs on the scale**
 - Visibly leaner with more ab definition
 - Maintaining the majority of muscle mass despite deep caloric deficit
 - Dramatically improved sleep
 - Significantly more energy / reduced caffeine dependence
 - Reduced chronic joint and tissue pain

Peptide	Primary Role	Secondary Role
Tirzepatide	Fat loss (appetite suppression)	Insulin sensitivity, some focus
Tesamorelin	Visceral fat reduction	Muscle preservation, better sleep
MOTS-c	Energy & mitochondrial output	Metabolic flexibility, some recovery
Ipamorelin	GH release, fat loss (lipolysis)	Sleep quality, muscle recovery
BPC-157	Injury healing & recovery	Gut inflammation, minor muscle protection

The biggest takeaway: stacking these five peptides under medical supervision produced compounding effects — fat loss attacked from multiple angles simultaneously while sleep, energy, and recovery all improved, making a deep caloric deficit feel sustainable rather than depleting.

- Plans to share **week-4 bloodwork** in a follow-up video to show physiological markers
- Reiterates: get a doctor, get bloodwork, do not self-source peptides from unverified suppliers